JAMES MITCHELL

Senior Software Engineer | Platform Architecture | System Design

Email: james.mitchell@gmail.com

Phone: +40 721 445 892

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jamesmitchell-engineer

GitHub: github.com/jmitchell-eng

Location: London, United Kingdom

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 12 years of hands-on experience building scalable distributed systems and leading platform architecture initiatives. I've spent the last eight years working on high-throughput backend services handling millions of requests daily, with a particular focus on cloud infrastructure and database optimization. I thrive in environments where I can mentor junior engineers while tackling complex technical problems that require both deep systems knowledge and pragmatic problem-solving.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer, Platform Infrastructure

Velocity Systems

velocity-systems.io, London

January 2022 - Present

Architected and delivered a service mesh migration that reduced infrastructure costs by 34% while improving deployment safety for 12 microservices serving 50 million daily active users.

Established the technical strategy for the platform team and mentored four senior engineers through a career progression framework, with two subsequently promoted to staff level.

Led the design and implementation of a custom event streaming platform replacing Kafka, reducing operational overhead by 60% and cutting infrastructure spend by 220,000 GBP annually.

Built a comprehensive observability stack using OpenTelemetry and Prometheus that reduced mean time to detection for production incidents from 18 minutes to 3 minutes.

Senior Software Engineer, Backend Systems

DataFlow Technologies

dataflow-tech.co, London

July 2018 - December 2021

Designed and implemented a distributed transaction coordinator handling 200,000 transactions per second across seven data centers, with a demonstrated 99.99% availability over 18 months.

Refactored the core payment processing service which reduced latency by 65% and eliminated a chronic source of production incidents that had plagued the team for three years.

Established best practices for service reliability and code review standards that became the baseline for 15 engineering teams across the organization.

Collaborated with product and operations to successfully decompose a monolithic application into 18 independent services, enabling 40% faster deployment cycles.

Backend Engineer, Infrastructure

ByteScale Ltd

www.bytescale.com, London

March 2016 - June 2018

Developed and maintained core backend services and APIs serving the company's primary product, implemented caching strategies that improved response times by 70% for read-heavy operations.

Led the migration of our legacy infrastructure from self-hosted servers to AWS, managing the operational complexity and coordinating with cross-functional teams to ensure zero downtime.

Implemented automated performance testing and profiling tools that identified several critical bottlenecks in the database layer, resulting in 3x improvement in query response times.

Mentored a team of three junior developers, conducting weekly technical reviews and guiding two of them through their promotion to mid-level engineer.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Runtimes: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Rust, Node.js

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, ECS), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Cassandra

Distributed Systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Service Mesh, Distributed Tracing

Tools and Platforms: Git, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, PagerDuty, Jira

Architecture Patterns: Microservices, Event-driven systems, CQRS, Saga pattern, Eventual consistency

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmitchell-eng/distributed-cache - Go implementation of a distributed caching layer with consistent hashing, 1.2k stars

github.com/jmitchell-eng/service-mesh-tools - Collection of utilities for Istio service mesh operations and debugging, 680 stars

github.com/jmitchell-eng/performance-profiler - Python profiling tool for identifying performance bottlenecks in high-throughput services, 520 stars

github.com/jmitchell-eng/kafka-patterns - Examples and patterns for building event-driven systems with Kafka, 890 stars